



MONTHLY UPDATE

Eritrea: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-02 · 5 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION

Summary of the month

Five rows move in the month, and four of them establish an absence rather than a system — which is the characteristic shape of this base. A legal-research pass dated 1 August [re-verified that no comprehensive data-protection law is in force, no supervisory authority exists and no enforcement decisions have been published](#). The postal union's August addressing reference [does not list Eritrea among the countries operating a postal-code system](#). Against those, two things exist: a water project [held geodesign workshops in Asmara with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants](#), and the state telecommunications provider [runs a live web complaint form for internet faults](#). The month's one piece of ordinary news is a software collective: on 15 August the information ministry [interviewed Shambko Apps Group, which has released five Tigrinya-language mobile applications](#) built to the national curriculum. Eritrean reporting on this base remains limited to the information ministry's own outlet and a diaspora one.

Governance

Data protection

The data-protection position was re-verified rather than changed. A legal-research pass dated 1 August 2026 [records no comprehensive data-protection law in force, no supervisory authority established and no enforcement decisions published](#). What the month adds is the date, not the finding: the absence is now a searched one rather than an unexamined one. It agrees with a regional ministerial assessment placing Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight, and with a trade regulatory profile recording no data-protection officer, impact-assessment or retention requirements. Three independent assessments across four years say the same thing, which is what distinguishes a reported absence from an unexamined one.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Outside consultation reached Asmara. A water-security project [held two rounds of geodesign workshops in July 2026 with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants, alongside a hydrological-modelling training session for Eritrean technical experts](#). It is the convener's own account of process, and it sits against a state the record elsewhere describes as silencing criticism systematically.

DPI

Registries

The month establishes an absence rather than a system. The postal union's addressing reference, dated August 2026, [does not list Eritrea among the countries that require or use a postal-code system](#), so there is no national postcode scheme. Nothing on the record names another national addressing scheme, digital or otherwise. The reference does not itself say whether one is planned, and no street-naming programme, digital addressing initiative or geocoding of the population registers appears anywhere on the record. The registers themselves remain six separate regional systems with no central national register, so an address held in one is not resolvable from another.

Technology

Innovation ecosystem

On 15 August the Ministry of Information [interviewed Shambko Apps Group, a self-organised software collective that has released five Tigrinya-language mobile applications](#) — literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools built to the national curriculum — and set out a plan to extend them to Eritrea's eight other national languages. It is the first non-state software effort the base holds for Eritrea. No download count, distribution channel or funding source is stated, and the account is the state broadcaster's own.

Inclusion

Access to services

One digital feedback channel is on the record, and it belongs to the operator rather than the state. The sole state telecommunications provider [runs a live web form for internet-connectivity, website-access and web-application complaints, with telephone and email alternatives](#). No whole-of-government complaint route is recorded, and no volume of complaints made or resolved is published.

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